

El Tri Match Schedule



Mexico's official home opener kicks off at Estadio Azteca. If you're planning to catch the action, keep these dates in mind:

- **June 11: Mexico vs. South Africa** – Estadio Azteca, Mexico City (~2:00 PM CT) · *Opening / Home Match*
- **June 18: Mexico vs. South Korea** – Estadio Akron, Guadalajara · *Away Day Trip*
- **June 24: Czechia vs. Mexico** – Estadio Azteca, Mexico City · *Final Group Stage Match (Home)*

If you still need to lock down your spot, you can check ticket options via [SeatGeek](#) or [StubHub](#).

Where to Stay

Depending on the vibe you are looking for, stick to these top tourist-safe neighborhoods:

- **Roma Norte:** Trendy, highly walkable, packed with incredible restaurants and nightlife. Features excellent metro access to the rest of the city.
- **Condesa:** Peaceful, bohemian vibe characterized by beautiful tree-lined streets. Very safe and located right next door to Reforma.
- **Polanco:** Upscale neighborhood with elite security located right near Chapultepec Park. This is the absolute best option for luxury stays.

 **Tip:** Use Booking.com or HotelTonight immediately to secure remaining last-minute availabilities across these neighborhoods, as spaces are filling up fast.

Getting to Estadio Azteca

Navigating to the stadium via public transit is straightforward and highly affordable if you follow these steps:

1. **Metro Line 2 (Blue):** Board at your nearest central station and ride south all the way to the terminal station, **Tasqueña**.

2. **Tren Ligero Transfer:** Follow the signs at Tasqueña to connect directly to the Tren Ligero (Light Rail) and ride it down to the dedicated **Estadio Azteca** stop.
3. **Travel Time:** Plan for **45–75 minutes** from central CDMX.

Match Day Pro-Tips:

- Buy an **Integrated Mobility Card** at any metro station ahead of time.
- On match days, leave **3–4 hours early** to handle the crowds. Extra FIFA shuttles will run throughout the city.
- If you get stuck, ride-sharing apps like **Uber or DiDi** are always reliable premium backups.

Teotihuacán Pyramids Day Trip

A sunrise hot air balloon flight over the ancient pyramids at dawn is a definitive bucket-list moment.

- **The Experience:** Pickup is usually around 4:00–5:00 AM. Costs average \$150–\$270 USD including transportation and breakfast. You can book this ahead of time on Viator or GetYourGuide.
- **Hours & Entry:** Open 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM. Entry is roughly ~\$4–5 USD. Arrive precisely at opening to completely beat the massive tour groups.
- **Best Way to Go:** Book a fully guided tour with hotel pickup (\$50–\$120) or catch a highly affordable public bus directly from the *Autobuses del Norte* station.

- **Pyramid Climbing Note:** Full summits of the Pyramid of the Sun are restricted. However, lower platforms and base steps remain open for incredible perspective photos.

Mexico City June Weather: What to Expect

June marks the official transition into Mexico City's **rainy season**, but it isn't an all-day wash.

- **Temperatures:** Very comfortable. Expect average daytime highs around **75°F to 78°F** and refreshing, cool evenings dropping down to around **55°F to 57°F**.
- **Rain Patterns:** Mornings are typically bright or partly cloudy, making them perfect for sightseeing. The rain usually hits in the **late afternoon or evening** as sudden, heavy downpours or thunderstorms.
- **What to Pack:** Layers are your best friend. Bring light t-shirts for the daytime, a comfortable jacket or sweater for the chilly evenings, and a reliable waterproof rain jacket or compact umbrella for those afternoon match-day showers.

Staying Safe in Mexico City

- **Stick to Safe Zones:** Limit your lodging and late-night exploring to Roma, Condesa, Polanco, Reforma, and the Zócalo.
- **Transportation:** Use Uber or DiDi apps only—**never** hail unmarked street taxis.
- **Valuables:** Lock your physical passport in the hotel safe and keep main valuables hidden while walking.

- **Altitude & Weather:** CDMX is at a high altitude. Hydrate constantly and pace your alcohol intake. June also marks the start of the local rainy season.
- **Emergency:** The local emergency contact number is **911**. It is highly recommended to register your trip with the US STEP program and download the official CDMX safety app.
- **Stadium Bags & Logistics:** Estadio Azteca enforces strict bag policies during major FIFA events. Avoid bringing large backpacks; stick to small, clear bags or small clutches. Give yourself at least **3 to 4 hours** to get to the stadium on June 11th—traffic will be dense.
- **Altitude & Hydration:** At over 7,300 feet above sea level, dehydration hits much faster. Drink plenty of bottled water (avoid tap water entirely, including ice at smaller street stalls) and pace yourself if you are drinking alcohol at the fan zones.
- **Crowd Safety:** Pickpocketing rises in heavy crowds. Wear a cross-body bag zipped to the front, keep your phone out of your back pocket, and leave your physical passport locked in your hotel safe (carry a digital photo of it on your phone instead).

Packing Checklist

Make sure you have these essentials packed before you head to MCI for your flight:

- ☐ Passport + Match Tickets
- ☐ Integrated Mobility Card (purchase upon arrival)
- ☐ Comfortable walking shoes
- ☐ High-SPF sunscreen + light rain jacket

- [] Premium travel insurance
- [] Cash (Pesos) + Credit Card
- [] Portable phone charger
- [] Offline Google Maps downloaded

Special Help & Emergency Numbers

Save these numbers directly into your phone before you take off from MCI:

- **911 (General Emergency):** The standard, universal number for immediate police, fire, or ambulance services in Mexico.
- **078 (Ángeles Verdes / Green Angels):** If you take an express bus or drive out to Guadalajara for the June 18th match against South Korea, this dispatch line connects you to the "Green Angels." They provide free mechanical help, roadside assistance, and tourist medical support on all major federal highways.
- **01 800 008 9090 (Sectur Tourist Assistance):** A dedicated, bilingual hotline provided by the Ministry of Tourism for general tourist support, guidance, or non-emergency assistance.
- **911 CDMX App:** Download this official app onto your phone upon arrival. It features a localized "panic button" that routes your exact GPS coordinates to local authorities if you get lost or need assistance in the city.

For a last-minute trip to Mexico City for the World Cup, a few high-priority items will save you a massive headache if you sort them out right now.

Here is what you need to lock down immediately:

Money & Payments (Crucial Prep)

- **Inform Your Bank:** Do this today. Drop a travel notice on your credit and debit cards so they don't get frozen for "suspicious international activity" the first time you try to buy tacos or merch.
- **Get a No-Foreign-Transaction-Fee Card:** If you have one, make it your primary card.
- **Cash is King for Street Food:** While Roma, Condesa, and Polanco are highly digital, stadium vendors, street taco stalls, and market vendors only take cash (Pesos). Use a bank ATM inside a secure building (like a bank branch) when you land to get local cash—avoid the airport exchange booths with terrible rates.

Connectivity & Communication

- **Set up an eSIM:** Don't rely on finding a physical SIM card at the airport. Download an app like Airalo or Holafly *before* you leave MCI to install a digital Mexican data eSIM. Alternatively, check if your current US carrier (like T-Mobile or Verizon) includes free roaming in Mexico.
- **Download Google Translate Offline:** Cellular data can get incredibly congested and drop entirely inside a packed Estadio

Azteca. Download the Spanish language pack offline so you can translate signs and menus without a signal.

- **Download Google Maps Offline:** Select the entire Mexico City metropolitan area and download the map offline so your GPS works even without data.

Electronics

- **Power Plugs:** Mexico uses the same Type A and Type B plugs as the US, so you won't need a physical adapter.
- **Heavy-Duty Power Bank:** Between taking videos at the match, navigating via GPS, and ordering Ubers, your phone battery will drain fast. Bring a high-capacity portable charger (10,000mAh+) to keep with you on match days.

Airport & Logistics

Mexico Immigration & The FMM Card - Aeropuerto Internacional Benito Juárez (MEX)

- **The Paper Slip:** Depending on your airline, you might be handed a paper **FMM (Forma Migratoria Múltiple)** tourist card on the plane, or immigration will stamp your passport and write in a set number of days. If you *are* handed a physical paper slip at the border, **do not lose it**. Put it straight into your passport or hotel safe; you must surrender it when exiting the country, or you will face a cash fine and annoying airport delays on your way home.

- **Terminal Differences:** MEX has two main terminals (Terminal 1 and Terminal 2) connected by the *Aaerotrén* monorail. Make sure you know which terminal your airline flies out of for your return flight so you don't get stuck on the wrong side of the airport.

Getting Cash Safely at MEX Airport

- **Avoid the Exchange Booths:** The prominent currency exchange booths scattered throughout the main arrivals halls offer notoriously terrible exchange rates.
- **Use Bank ATMs Only:** Instead, walk slightly past the main exits to locate an official, walled-in bank branch ATM (look for names like BBVA, Santander, or Banamex) inside the terminal. Use your debit card to withdraw Pesos directly.
- **The "Decline Conversion" Trick:** When the ATM asks if you want to accept their conversion rate, **choose "Decline Conversion."** The machine will still give you your cash, but your home bank will handle the currency conversion rate instead, saving you an easy 5% to 10% in hidden fees.

Leaving the Airport Safely

- **Never Take an Unmarked Taxi:** When you walk out of baggage claim, people will approach you offering rides. **Ignore them completely.** * **Option A (App-Based):** Fire up your **Uber** or **DiDi** app. Both work perfectly at MEX, though you may need to walk to a designated airport pickup zone (the app will tell you exactly which gate/door to stand at).

- **Option B (Authorized Taxis):** If you prefer a traditional cab, look for the official, brightly colored "**Taxis Autorizados**" booths *inside* the terminal building. You pay a flat, zone-based rate directly to the cashier at the booth, they hand you a paper ticket, and you take that ticket outside to the official taxi line.

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